

MailFlow, from first sign-in to first reply

Email students from your own Gmail: import a batch, write one template, preview it per student, get it approved, send, and see every reply threaded back to the student it came from. Nothing goes out without a dry run and a human decision.

Sign in with your Google account **Sends from** your own Gmail address

Approval required before any campaign sends

01 Day-one setup

Do these in order. The whole thing takes about five minutes.

- 1 **Sign in** at mailflow-six-sooty.vercel.app with **Continue with Google**.
- 2 **Connect Gmail:** **Settings** → Gmail → **Connect**. Approve the two permissions (send, read). MailFlow sends *from your own address* and never as anyone else. If Google says "Gmail API has not been used", tell the super admin — it is enabled once for the project.
- 3 **Check your role** in Settings → Profile. If it is wrong, a super admin changes it (see §2).
- 4 **Pick a theme** at the bottom of the sidebar: System, Light or Dark. Remembered per browser.
- 5 **Send yourself a test:** Templates → any template → **Send test email**. Confirm it lands before your first campaign.

02 Roles

ROLE	CAN DO
Viewer	Read everything in their workspace. Cannot edit, send or reply.
Operator	Import data, build templates and campaigns, run dry runs, submit for approval, send approved campaigns, reply in the Inbox, run automations.
Admin	Everything an Operator can, plus approve or reject campaigns in workspaces they belong to, and <i>Send without approval</i> for their own. Cannot approve their own campaign.

Super Admin	Everything, organisation-wide: Approvals for all workspaces, Users, Workspaces, All Data, All Conversations, Audit Logs, System Settings, Organization analytics, and read-only, audited <i>View workspace as</i> .
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Every person has their own **workspace**: their datasets, templates, campaigns and inbox. Nobody else's workspace is visible unless a super admin opens it with View As.

03 The core workflow

3.1 Import data DATA

- + Dataset, or Import → paste from Google Sheets or Excel, or upload CSV / XLSX.
- The preview detects headers and types and flags duplicate emails: Keep first, Keep latest, or Import all.
- **Set the email column's type to EMAIL** (the small type selector under the column header). That is what makes a dataset sendable and links each row to a Contact.

Importing never sends anything. Neither do previews, dry runs or AI suggestions.

3.2 Work the grid

- Double-click a cell to edit. Click a header to sort; again for descending; again to clear. Drag a header edge to resize. *Freeze first column* keeps names in view.
- Filter builds conditions in the same language as automations (equals, contains, is empty...). System fields such as *Email Status* and *Reply Received* are available.
- *Group by* any column shows counts per value. *Search* matches every column.
- Save view keeps a filter, sort and grouping under a name for everyone using the dataset.
- **Bulk edit**: tick rows → *Set column... to value* → Apply. Each change is recorded per record; automations that trigger on updates will evaluate, and the confirmation says so.
- Columns panel: show, hide, rename, reorder, delete. Rows:  duplicates,  deletes.

3.3 Write a template TEMPLATES

- Subject and body use variables from the dataset: `{{Name}}`, `{{Deadline}}`. Insert them from + Insert variable so the spelling matches the column.

- *Preview* as a real student shows resolved values; unresolved variables are listed in yellow. Check layout with the width slider or the Desktop / Mobile presets.
- **AI assistant** (left panel): describe the email → **Generate** → **Insert**. Improve, Shorten, More professional, Fix grammar and Translate rewrite the current body. Subject ideas and Check personalisation are advisory.
- **Format** pretty-prints the HTML without changing how it renders. **Run health check** before saving: it catches missing variables, a non-EMAIL recipient column, broken links and a missing mailbox.
- **Save new version**: every save is a new immutable version. Campaigns pin the version they were created with, so editing a template later never changes an email that already went out.

3.4 Build a campaign **CAMPAIGNS**

- 1 **+ Campaign**: name, dataset, template. The template version is pinned at this moment.
- 2 **Sender settings**: From name, Reply-To, CC / BCC. CC and BCC go on *every* email in the campaign, so they are for supervisors and archives, not per student. The From address is always your connected Gmail.
- 3 **Run simulation**: exactly who would receive, who is skipped and why (invalid email, duplicate, automation stop condition). No email is sent.
- 4 **Review**: the exact headers and the rendered email per recipient. Read at least three.
- 5 **Submit for approval**. Approvers get an email from your Gmail with you in CC. You cannot approve your own campaign.
- 6 After approval, **Send now**. Sending creates a batch.

3.5 Approve **ADMINS**

- **Approvals** in the sidebar; the badge is the pending count. Tabs Pending, Approved, Rejected, All; search by campaign, requester or workspace.
- **Approve** takes optional internal remarks. **Reject** requires a reason, which the requester sees.
- The decision is emailed back **in the same thread** as the request. If nobody has Gmail connected, the decision still happens and the row says why the email was skipped.
- The campaign page shows the same buttons plus the full approval trail.

3.6 Watch the send **BATCHES**

- Every batch with live progress: sent, failed, skipped, and how many are still queued. It refreshes itself while anything is running.

- **Process queue** pushes queued emails through now. **Pause**, **Resume** and **Cancel** are immediate. **Retry failed** re-queues only the failures.
- Emails leave at 20 per minute per mailbox by default, so a 300-student batch takes about 15 minutes. Gmail also enforces its own daily limit on your account.

3.7 Replies **INBOX**

- Replies are pulled from your Gmail into the Inbox, only for threads MailFlow started. Push delivery is not on yet: click **Sync now** to fetch the latest.
- Bounces, out-of-office and auto-replies are classified automatically and never count as "the student replied".
- In a conversation: reply in the same thread or start a new one, add an internal note, tag, assign, set a follow-up, change status. **AI suggest reply** drafts text you can Insert and edit; **Summarise** gives a summary and a suggested next action that you choose whether to apply.
- Every conversation links to the Contact and the record it came from.

3.8 Contacts and History

- **Contacts:** a student's timeline across datasets — every email sent, every reply, notes and status changes.
- **History:** the immutable log. *Sent* lists every email with its outcome, reason and retries and a "Why?" explanation. *Received* lists every inbound message with its classification. Search and filter by status.

3.9 Dashboard

Live numbers for your workspace: emails sent, pending, failed, replies, unread, open conversations, follow-ups due; a 30-day send chart; the approvals chart; recent batches, conversations and activity; quick actions.

04 Automations

- An automation sends a template when a record matches conditions, for example **Trigger = 1 AND Status is empty**, on record created or updated, with a frequency policy and cooldown so nobody is emailed twice by mistake.
- **Stop conditions** such as *Reply Received = true* are checked first and always win.
- Enabling shows how many records it would affect *right now* and asks you to acknowledge that number. Run **Preview** first.

- Every run is listed with its result and a "Why?" explanation.

05 Super Admin tools

- **Users:** roles, enable and disable. Role changes are audited.
- **Workspaces:** every user's workspace with counts. **View Workspace** opens it read-only under a red *VIEWING WORKSPACE AS* banner; **Exit View** leaves. Entry and exit are audited. This never grants access to someone else's Gmail.
- **All Data** and **All Conversations:** organisation-wide lists with search and filters. Every view is audited.
- **Organization:** users, workspaces, emails, replies, failure rate, campaign performance, approvals and user activity over 7, 30 or 90 days.
- **Audit Logs:** who did what, when.
- **System Settings:** retention policy (configuration and impact preview only; nothing is deleted automatically), AI provider status, limits and usage, sign-in restriction.

06 Before you send

Tick these off for every campaign. Ticks are saved in this browser.

- ☐ Gmail connected and a **test email** received.
- ☐ Email column set to **EMAIL**; duplicates handled at import.
- ☐ Every `{{variable}}` resolves in **Preview as** for at least three students.
- ☐ **Health check** passes. Warnings are fine; failures are not.
- ☐ **Dry run** count matches what you expect, and every skip reason makes sense.
- ☐ From name, Reply-To and CC / BCC are right. CC and BCC go on *every* email.
- ☐ Read the rendered email in **Review**.
- ☐ Submitted for approval, and the approver has opened the Review page.

- ☐ After sending: watched the batch to completion in **Batches** and checked failures in **History**.

0 of 9 done

[Reset for the next campaign](#)

07 Limits to know

Only four things send email: *Send now* on an approved campaign, *Send without approval* by an admin, a reply you click Send on, and an enabled automation. Nothing else does.

- **Gmail limits.** Google caps sends per account per day: typically 500 for an @gmail.com address and 2,000 for Workspace. MailFlow paces at 20 per minute; failures appear in History with the reason.
- **AI.** Gemini, 100 requests per person per day and 1,000 per organisation. On the free tier the provider sometimes rate-limits; the panel then says you can continue manually, and nothing else is affected.
- **Replies** are pulled, not pushed, for now: use *Sync now*. Attachments are listed but cannot be downloaded from MailFlow yet.
- **Grid.** Datasets over 5,000 rows are filtered over the first 5,000, and the page says so.
- **Approval emails** need a connected Gmail on the requester for the request, and on the reviewer or the requester for the decision.
- **Sign-in** is open to any Google account today. Ask the super admin to restrict it to @masaischool.com once everyone is onboarded.

08 If something goes wrong

SYMPTOM	DO THIS
Sign-in fails	Try again. "Not permitted" means the account was disabled: contact a super admin.
Gmail connect errors	Settings → Gmail → Connect again, choosing your own Masai account.
"Sender not connected"	Connect Gmail in Settings, then re-run the health check.

SYMPTOM	DO THIS
Batch stuck in Preparing or Queued	Batches → <i>Process queue</i> . If it keeps failing, open History for the error.
No replies appearing	Inbox → <i>Sync now</i> . Replies are only pulled for threads MailFlow started.
AI says unavailable or limit reached	Continue manually and try later. Admins see usage in System Settings.
Can't find Approve	Only Admins and Super Admins see Approvals, and you cannot approve your own campaign.

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